

NewsGuard Review

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1 Introduction

In the past years, the spread of misinformation has been studied extensively by scholars from different scientific disciplines, therefore, relying on diverse conceptualizations: definitions of misinformation vary across the concerned academic disciplines and results heavily depend on the particular study design (REFs).

In practice, however, it is challenging to draw a line on truth; and it is even more challenging to identify the exact intention behind a misleading tweet (REF). Concerning the latter dimension (the intention), scholars distinguish disinformation and fake news, typically pushing an economic or political agenda, from other types of false information with no particular or unclear purpose (Wardle & Derakhshan, 2017). In observational research concentrating on perceptive aspects instead of the exact intention, researchers often apply misinformation as an umbrella term (Weeks & Gil de Zúñiga, 2021). We follow this rationale that shifts the focus to the outcome rather than the production of misinformation and account for the second dimension (the facticity) by treating news reliability as a continuum.

Underestimation of subtle types of misinformation: Few people are exposed to misinformation, but most people have partisan information diets. Here, falseness is a continuum, and misinformation is a means to an end. Therefore, the degree of falseness is central to capturing the problem scope and, especially for computational scientists, reviewing this phenomenon at the scale of the information ecosystem.

Inconsistencies in conceptualizations are reflected in operationalizations, especially across fields. Imprecision in how we call things then results in imprecise evidence. **EXAMPLE.** Therefore, we review different approaches to measuring misinformation online in terms of reliability, validity and feasibility and come to a conclusion that the purpose matters. We then focus on one perspective in particular that has recently gained popularity: domain-based approaches. Relying on one case study, we compare the NewsGuard list with misinformation in Telegram channels based on two dimensions: completeness and quality/bias.

2 NewsGuard description

Here, we add Ruggeros descriptive analysis of NewsGuard.